DATA ITEM DESCRIPTION

Title: USSF INCIDENT RESPONSE PLAN (IRP)

Number: DI-SCRE-82551
AMSC Number: 10685
DTIC Applicable: No
Preparing Activity: 19 (SSC)
Applicable Forms: N/A

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Limitation: N/A
GIDEP Applicable: No
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Use/relationship: This Data Item Description (DID) defines the format and content requirements for the Incident Response Plan (IRP) deliverable. The IRP provides a comprehensive framework for managing cyber incidents within the USSF Enterprise.

a. The IRP outlines roles, responsibilities, procedures, and coordination mechanisms for incident detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident activities. The IRP is used by the Mission Delta 6 (MD 6) Cyber Warfare Operations Center (CWOC), Cyber Force Elements (CFE), Mission Owners, System Owners, and other stakeholders involved in cybersecurity incident management.

b. This DID is used to ensure that the IRP is complete, consistent, and aligned with applicable DoD and USSF policies and guidelines.

Requirements:

1. Reference documents.

    a. Delta 6 Security Operations Center Cyber Incident Response Plan, 6 Feb 2025.

    b. The NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) 2.0.

    c. NIST Special Publication 800-61 Rev. 3 (or latest), *Cybersecurity Incident Response Recommendations and Considerations for Cybersecurity Risk Management*.

2. Format. The IRP shall be delivered as a Microsoft Word document (.docx) and a Portable Document Format (.pdf) document containing selectable, searchable text (scanned images are not acceptable).

3. Content. The IRP shall include the following sections:

    a. Revision History: A record of all document versions, release dates, authors, and a description of changes.

    b. Introduction: Purpose, Scope (systems, networks, and data covered), Applicability (organizations and personnel to whom the IRP applies).

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c. Applicable Documents: A comprehensive list of all referenced documents, governing directives, policies, and system-specific documentation.

d. Roles and Responsibilities: Detailed description of the roles and responsibilities of organizations and contact information of key positions/personnel involved in incident response, (e.g. MD 6 CWOC, Cyber Force Elements (CFE), Mission Owners (e.g., CFC Mission Deltas and CSqs), System Owners (e.g., SSC PMOs), Information System Security Manager (ISSM), Information System Security Officer (ISSO), Legal Counsel, Public Affairs, Law Enforcement (LE), and Counterintelligence (CI)).

e. Incident Management.

(1) Incident Management Overview: A description of the overall incident management lifecycle, which shall align with the NIST CSF 2.0 Respond (RS) function and incorporate the phases of Preparation, Detection and Analysis, Containment, Eradication, Recovery, and Post-Incident Activity.

(2) Execution and Coordination (RS.MA-01): A description of how the incident response plan is executed, ensuring coordination with all relevant internal and external parties.

(3) Triage and Validation (RS.MA-02): Procedures for validating and triaging incoming incident reports to confirm their legitimacy and assess initial impact.

(4) Categorization and Prioritization (RS.MA-03): A reference to the criteria (detailed in section 3.h) used to categorize and prioritize incidents to guide the response.

(5) Escalation (RS.MA-04): Procedures for escalating incidents and elevating notifications to higher authorities or external organizations as required.

(6) Recovery Initiation (RS.MA-05): The criteria that must be met to formally begin the incident recovery phase.

f. Policy: A detailed summary of information required for incident handling:

(1) Notification Guidelines: Procedures and contact methods for reporting potential incidents.

(2) Information Disclosure: Policy defining "need-to-know" and procedures for handling requests for information, including the use of Non-Disclosure Agreements.

(3) Security Classification: Guidelines for assigning a security classification to an incident and its related data, distinct from its severity category.

(4) Negligent Disclosure of Classified Information (NDCI): A detailed workflow for handling incidents involving the spillage of classified information, immediate actions, reporting channels (e.g., AMAC SharePoint), and MFR requirements.

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(5) Incident Response Data Retention and Event/Incident Tracking Management: A description of the data retention and event/incident tracking mechanisms and management.

(6) Law Enforcement / Counterintelligence (LE/CI) Coordination: Specific procedures outlining when and how to notify and engage with LE/CI entities (e.g., AFOSI), including which incident categories require mandatory reporting.

g. Cyber Incident Response Tiers:

(1) Description of the tiered C2 construct (Tier I - Global, Tier II - Regional/Theater, Tier III - Local).

(2) Roles, Responsibilities, and communication requirements for each tier. (Note: The "Tiers" described in this section refer to a C2 hierarchy for incident response coordination and are distinct from the "Cybersecurity Tiers" defined in the NIST CSF 2.0, which characterize the maturity of an organization’s risk management practices.)

h. Incident Categorization and Prioritization:

(1) Criteria for categorizing incidents based on severity, impact, and type (e.g., CAT 1-9).

(2) Prioritization guidelines for allocating resources and response efforts.

(3) Reporting requirements for different incident categories.

i. Incident Response Procedures:

(1) CSSP Alignment: The IRP must include the following statement to ensure alignment with the CSSP: "This incident response plan (IRP) aligns with the Mission Delta 6 (MD 6) Cyberspace Warfare Operations Center (CWOC) IRP for cyber incident reporting. All cyber incidents will be reported according to the established channels outlined in the MD 6 CWOC IRP Section 7.0, Policy. This IRP will follow the incident response phases described in the MD 6 CWOC IRP Section 8.0, Phases of Incident Response, to ensure consistent handling and reporting of all cyber events."

(2) Incident Handling Procedures: This section shall contain the specific step-by-step procedures for the key phases of incident response: containment, eradication, and recovery. It must detail the handling of different incident types (e.g., malware infections, data breaches, insider threats, denial-of-service attacks). These procedures must primarily align with the NIST CSF 2.0 categories for Incident Analysis (RS.AN) and Incident Mitigation (RS.MI). When an incident involves a third party, the procedures must also address coordination with relevant suppliers, aligning with Cybersecurity Supply Chain Risk Management (GV.SC) principles.

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(3) Evidence Collection and Preservation: Guidance on evidence collection, handling, and preservation to maintain chain of custody.

(4) Testing and Exercise Plan: A plan for periodic testing of the IRP, which is to be conducted at least annually. This shall include tabletop exercises, simulations, or other methods to validate the procedures and training of the incident response team, consistent with the principles of NIST CSF 2.0 category ID.IM-02. It will also describe the process for documenting lessons learned from these exercises and incorporating them into subsequent IRP updates

j. Reporting and Communication:

(1) Procedures for reporting incidents to internal and external stakeholders.

(2) Templates for incident reports, notifications, and briefings.

(3) Communication protocols for coordinating response efforts.

(4) Incident Tracking System: Identification and procedures for using the official system of record (e.g., Rally) for incident tracking, management, and reporting.

k. Pre-Approved Actions (PAA):

(1) A list of pre-approved containment, eradication, and recovery actions.

(2) For each PAA, define the Delegated Authority, Executing organization, Lead/Observed parties, and Justification.

l. Post-Incident Activities:

(1) Procedures for conducting post-incident reviews, After-Action Reports (AAR), and lessons learned.

(2) Requirements for updating security policies, procedures, and training materials.

(3) Effectiveness Metrics and Maturity Assessment: This section shall describe the specific metrics to be used for measuring incident response effectiveness and detail the methodology and schedule for conducting a periodic Maturity Assessment of the IRP. This described methodology must explain how the assessment will evaluate the plan's effectiveness, identify gaps, and provide a roadmap for improvement, using the NIST CSF Tiers (e.g., Tier 1: Partial, Tier 2: Risk-Informed, Tier 3: Repeatable, Tier 4: Adaptive) as a benchmark for measuring progress.

m. Deconfliction: Procedures to deconflict with Red Team activities.

End of DI-SCRE-82551

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